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Notes from Oak

September 19, 2025

LASD
Los Altos School District



Los Altos
Educational
Foundation

OAK
PTA



You!



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Principal's Message

Dear Oak community,
Happy Friday!

Calling All Playground Heroes!

Our students have endless energy, and while that's wonderful for learning and play... it also means we could use a few extra hands at lunch recess! For the next couple of weeks, we're looking for some amazing volunteers to help with noon duty. Think of it as

front-row seats to the best soccer debates, the most creative Gaga ball strategies, our Friday K-pop concerts and the occasional "am I out or not" negotiations. It's also a great way to get your steps in while spending time with our wonderful students!

If you're able to join us—even for a day—we'd be so grateful. Your presence makes a huge difference in keeping recess safe, fun, and kind for all. Plus, you'll earn unofficial superhero status in the eyes of our students. 🦸‍♂️ ✨

Please email me or just show up when your schedule allows.

Thank you
Nikita



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Join Us for Coffee On 9/26

Oak PTA invites all parents to the Parent Social & Coffee Chat on Friday, September 26, 8:30-10:00am in the Multipurpose Room.

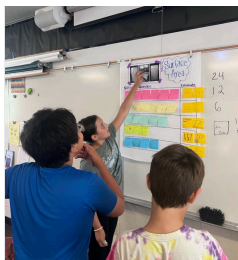


This is a kid-free opportunity to get to know other parents and learn more about our school and community over coffee and food. There will also be an opt-in icebreaker with prizes and a Q&A panel featuring Principal Shah and some seasoned parents.

Feel free to submit questions about Oak for the Q&A [HERE](#).



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6th Grade Math Exploring Surface Area



6th Graders Enjoying Free Time with Connect Four



6th Grade Using Ratios to Compare Speed & Distance

Important Dates

- **Fri, Sept 26** - Oak in Motion - 8:15am on Blacktop
- **Fri, Sept 26** - New Parent Welcome Coffee - 8:30-10am in Multi
- **Thur, Oct 2** - 5th Grade Authors' Faire - 1-1:30 in classroom(s)
- **Fri, Oct 3** - Oak in Motion - 8:15am on Blacktop
- **Sat, Oct 4** - Walkathon - 9am-12pm on Oak Field
- **Wed, Oct 8** - 4th Grade Walk Thru CA - Multi
- **Thurs, Oct 9** - **Minimum Day - Students Out at 12:15pm**
- **Thurs, Oct 9** - LASD AI Playlab - 1-2:30pm at Covington
- **Fri, Oct 10** - **Teacher In-Service - No School**
- **Fri, Oct 17** - Oak in Motion - 8:15am on Blacktop
- **Wed, Oct 22** - Picture Re-take Day
- **Fri, Oct 31** - Oak Spooktacular - In Multi - 2:30pm - Kinders; 3pm - Older Kids

Helpful Links

LASD 2025-26 District Calendar [here](#)

Oak Website oakschool.org/

Breakfast & Lunch Menus <https://www.lasdschools.org/menus>

PTA Corner

Upcoming Events:

1. **Parent Welcome Coffee** - Friday, Sept 26th, 2025 from 8:30-10am.
2. **Oak School Walkathon** - Saturday, October 4th from 9am - 12pm

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Oak Walkathon is fast approaching on Saturday, October 4th and we would love for your family to participate!

Here are 3 ways to get ready:

- 1) [Register](#) your child (first class to reach 100% registration gets a popsicle party)
- 2) Help your child get pledges/donations by using our handy [email template](#) (class with the most pledges/donations per student wins a popsicle party)
- 3) [Volunteer](#) for a shift or 2 (pro tip: we just opened [volunteer signups](#) so sign up early to get your ideal duty and shift!).



Remember, the Walkathon is a celebration of our Oak community, but is also powered by our Oak community, so please register, fundraise and volunteer!

All students  **smore**

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anyway!) so we will see you on October 4th!

Volunteer Opportunities

We hope you got a chance to sign up for the many different volunteer opportunities at the booths at our Back-to-school events. If you missed it, and would like to learn more about getting involved, please complete the Oak Volunteer Sign up form:

<https://rb.gy/fdbley>



Lunch Service Volunteers needed!

The California-sponsored Universal Meals Program offers breakfast and lunch five days a week to all grades. The purpose of lunch service volunteers (from 11:55am - 12:30 pm) is to help monitor the lunch lines and release kids 5 at a time as lunch is served each day. It only takes a bit of time out of your day and you get to see what happens at lunchtime!

Noon Time Volunteers needed!

The Noon Play Program is to help create a safe, fun, and respectful lunch recess. Parent volunteers assist younger children with lunches and supervise the playground, field, garden, and blacktop areas. Volunteers typically work once a week or twice a month from 11:50am - 12:45pm. Younger siblings are always welcome to join parent volunteers. Filling the noon play shifts are critical in keeping a safe and happy recess at Oak.

Please email Amy Leung at aleung11@gmail.com if you have further questions.



Shout-Outs 🙌

A big thank you to our Staff Appreciation team—**Serena Hung, Jenny Brichko, Jane Lai, Emily Guy, and Tiffany Hickman**—for baking a delicious Cookie bar 🍪🍪🍪 this month to celebrate our amazing Oak teachers and administration!

Your thoughtful effort truly made the day special.

Sincerely,

Elizabeth Hernandez, President

Jocelyn Jackson, Executive Vice President

Oak Avenue PTA Executive Team 2025-2026

<https://www.lasdeducationpartners.org/>



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Los Altos Educational Foundation

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You!



OakReps@ LAEFOonline.org

Updates from your Oak LAEF Board Representatives

Rama Mulpuri & Shen Jackson

GET THE FULL SCOOP! How LAEF Funding Works

Parents and community members contribute to the Los Altos Educational Foundation (LAEF); **LAEF** provides a grant to the Los Altos School District (LASD); **LASD** hires teachers and ensures that the curriculum provides a well-rounded education at every school. Here's how the process works:

- **Public funds aren't enough** to provide the education we want for our students. LASD uses funds from the general fund, property and parcel taxes, grants, and other sources. It's still not enough! LAEF raises money to provide LASD with **additional funding** for teachers and programs.
- Each winter, **LASD determines its curriculum objectives** for the following school year and communicates its financial needs to LAEF.
- **LAEF identifies an appropriate fundraising goal** for the next school year based on the projected enrollment, recent giving trends, economic climate, and other factors.
- LAEF meets with the District to communicate how much money it can expect to receive from the foundation the following year. Then, **LASD and LAEF work together to identify the programs for which LAEF will raise funds**. This process results in an agreed-upon "Annual Grant" from LAEF to LASD for the following school year. **Details about [LAEF's Annual Grant](#) are publicly available every year**, so parents and the community know exactly how their donations are being spent and the funding breakdown between LASD and LAEF.

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teachers and staff.

By funding at the District level, LASD provides teachers across multiple schools that individual schools would not be able to afford on their own. For example, several schools may share a PE or music teacher, splitting the cost and time while all benefiting from the teacher's commitment to our students. PTAs are not allowed to fund classroom teachers. **Donations to LAEF are the only way to fund additional teaching staff at our schools.**

Thank you to those who have donated to LAEF this school year. If you have yet to give, [Donate Today!](#) A gift of any amount will make a difference for this school year.

Donate to both LAEF and the PTA to fund the resources and opportunities that turn an ordinary education into an LASD Education!

Learn more and donate at LAEFEducationPartners.org.



Library Corner

By Mrs. Forrest

We finally finished our mystery picture from last year - it's a cat with sunglasses! To encourage reading, I have the kids put on stickers for books read to reveal a mystery picture at the end of the school year. For K-1st, any book read qualifies for a sticker to put on our picture. For 2nd and 3rd, the student needs to read a 100+ page book. For 4th-6th, students need to read a 250+ page book. This is just another way to encourage more reading. I have a new mystery picture coming soon!

Library lessons this week included book care books and reviewing book care rules. In the upper grades, I also did some book talks for books that I read over the summer.

You can still sign your students up for Birthday Book Club via the Oak Classroom Parent website. Look for the tiny store icon along the top bar.

Students can still turn in their summer reading sheets to me in the library. I already have quite a stack! The deadline is September 30th.

How to visit the Oak School's Library Catalog via Destiny Discover:

Go to this



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Choose California, type in Los Altos School District, and Oak Avenue Elementary School in Los Altos. There are multiple Oak Avenue Schools, so make sure you pick the one in Los Altos. This puts you directly into the Oak Library Catalog, which shows all the books the Oak Library owns. Click Go!

You can browse the collection by topic, genre, grade level, etc. You can search for a specific book title or author. You don't need to log in to do any of these searches. However if you do want to put a book on hold or read one of our ebooks, you will need to log in.

To log in, click on the login button at the top right. Enter this year's google username and password that you use to log in to your school google account and submit. Search for the book you are looking for and put it on hold. Mrs. Forrest will pull the book for you and have it waiting for you in the library during the school year. No summer holds available.

Student Access to Santa Clara County Library

All LASD students (unless parents opted out), have a student account through the Santa Clara County Library District. This student account offers access to eBooks, research resources, homework help, and much more.

To access the website, go to: <https://student.scclld.org>

You will be asked to provide an Account Number and PIN. The Account Number is S + Student ID + LASD (no spaces in between). The student ID is a unique 5 digit number provided by LASD. It is the same number as your student's Powerschool number and is embedded in their school email address. The number is provided when you receive district communications specific to your student. The PIN is the student's birth month and day (again no spaces). If the birth month or day is only one number, add a zero in front of it.

For example:

Account Number: S12345LASD

PIN: 0114 (for January 14th)

There are also resource links on the Oak School website under Programs/Library.

Please contact Mrs. Forrest at cforrest@lasdschools.org if you have specific requests, have any questions, or have difficulty accessing your account.

Office Updates & Reminders

• Office  **smore**

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- **PowerSchool access:** send an email request to powerschoolsupport@lasdschools.org
- **Independent Study Plans**
 - Each student may utilize a maximum of 15 ISP days per school year
 - Please notify the office of the dates of absence as soon as possible. **Note: We request a two-week notice so teachers can prepare materials**
 - All Independent Study Plans are subject to principal approval
 - Work **MUST** be completed during the absence and returned to school on the student's first day back in class
 - For each day of absence, students are expected to complete 180 minutes of work
 - Parent to initiate the ISP. Please use this [2025-26 form](#)



Mission:

It is Oak School's mission to ensure high levels of learning for all students. Every day we respectfully collaborate to develop confident, resilient, joyful learners who care about the Oak School community and become responsible citizens.

Email: nshah@lasdschools.org

Website: oakschool.org/

Location: [1501 Oak Avenue, Los Altos, CA, USA](#)

Phone: [\(650\)237-3900](tel:(650)237-3900)

Lee Yazdani

Lee is using Smore to create beautiful newsletters

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